Introduction to Management MGNT110

Ms. Jesslyn Lau
Email: Jesslyn@uow.edu.au

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Introduction to Leadership

Lecture 3

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Learning Objectives

- Understand what leadership is
- Evaluate leadership theories
- See link between leadership & team performance
- Understand leadership as relational, contextual, and evolving
- Reflect on their own leadership

What makes someone a good leader?

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What is Leadership?

- Leadership is:
  - A relationship
  - A process of influence
  - Not just a position

Manager = authority
Leader = influence

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HISTORY OF LEADERSHIP

Classical Leadership

- Leader chosen by:
  - Birthright
  - Divine

Renaissance Leadership (Machiavelli)

- "Better to be feared than loved"
- Leadership = power, control

Modern Leadership

- Rise of corporations
- Still influenced by:
  - "Great Man" thinking

Family control

As of June, 2016
*Stake held in June, 2015

	Lee Kun-hee	Lee Jae-yong	Lee Bu-jin	Lee Seo-hyun
Samsung Electronics	3.44% (*3.88)	0.58% (*0.57)	-	-
Samsung C&T	2.86	17.23	-	-
Samsung SDS	0.01	9.2 (*11.25)	5.51	5.51
Samsung Life	20.76	0.06	3.9	3.9
Samsung Fire & Marine	-	0.09	-	-
Samsung Engineering	-	0 (*1.54)	-	-

Compiled by Kiwoom Securities/The Korea Herald

Corporate dynasties (Samsung)

Postmodern Leadership

- Leadership is:
  - Socially constructed
  - Contextual
  - Influenced by culture

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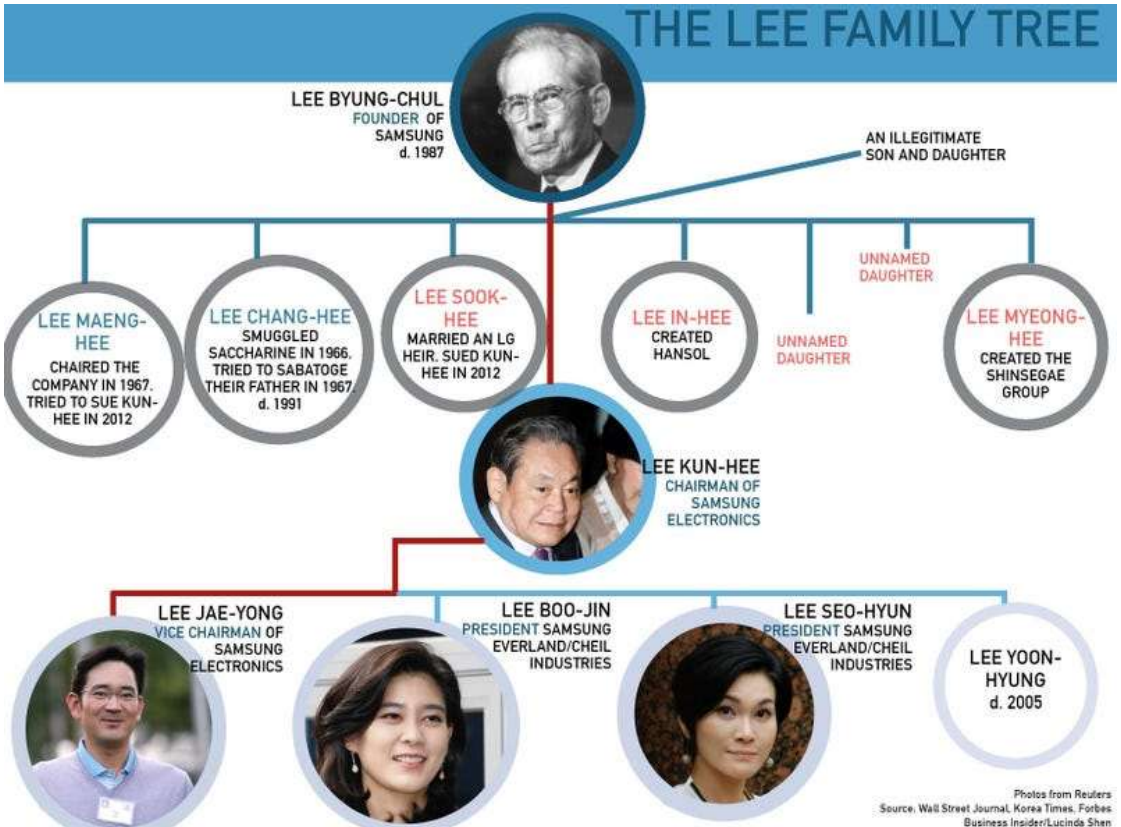

The Lee family - South Korea's largest *chaebol* (conglomerate), holding significant influence through an opaque network of cross-shareholdings.

HISTORY OF LEADERSHIP

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"transformational, visionary, and data-driven, blending high-stakes risk-taking with a hands-on, "hacker" ethos."

"calm, collaborative, and analytical, focusing on empowering teams and long-term sustainability rather than the autocratic, product-centric approach of Steve Jobs."

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Leadership moved
from ‘born leaders’ ➡ ‘context matters’

OLD	NEW
Leader = • hero • Top-down	Leadership = • shared • Relational

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Trait Theory

- Leaders are born with
  - Examples:
  - Confidence
  - Intelligence
  - Charisma
- Limitation:
  - Ignores context
  - Not everyone with traits becomes leader

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Ellen DeGeneres: I got kicked out of showbusiness

25 April 2024

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Annabel Rackham

Culture reporter

Ellen DeGeneres pictured in 2022

Ellen DeGeneres has made her return to the spotlight two years after the cancellation of her talk show.

She opened the first night of Ellen's Last Stand... Up Tour, her new comedy show which is also set to appear on Netflix.

The 66-year-old started her Hollywood show by saying "I didn't care what other people thought of me, and I realised... I said that at the height of my popularity".

DeGeneres has had a difficult few years, after employees on the Ellen DeGeneres show accused executive producers of over 'toxic workplace' claims.

'No mean people in show business'

Los Angeles Times

neline: The scandal that brought down Ellen DeGeneres' talk show

Ellen DeGeneres appears during a taping of the "The Ellen DeGeneres Show" in 2016. (Brooks Kraft / Getty Images)

By Los Angeles Times Staff

May 12, 2021 11:13 AM PT

Ellen DeGeneres announced Wednesday that her talk show was coming to an end after nearly two decades on the air.

News of her departure comes nearly a year after staffers on "The Ellen DeGeneres Show" reported a toxic work environment on set, prompting a televised apology from and shift in public perception toward the comedy icon, whose small-screen slogan is "Be kind to one another."

"My whole being is about making people happy," DeGeneres told the Hollywood Reporter of the allegations on confirming that her popular variety program would conclude next year. "And with the talk show, all I cared about was spreading kindness

Read More

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Behavioural Theory

- Leaders are defined by what they do
- Two types:
  - Task-oriented
  - People-oriented

Leadership can be learned

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Relational & Contemporary Leadership

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Leadership as RELATIONSHIP

- Leadership is relational, dynamically co-produced by leaders and followers, and dependent on trust and emotional intelligence.
  - Not just one powerful person
  - Relationship between the leader and the followers.
  - Created together through interaction, communication, trust, and influence.

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Distributed Leadership

- Distributed leadership means leadership is spread across the team, instead of being controlled only by one formal leader at the top.
- There is still leader but,
  - responsibility is distributed, not monopolised.
- Shared
  - Not just top-down
- Example:
  - Group project leader vs team influence
    - from leader to team, from team to leader, between team members themselves (not a straight line)

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Leader–Member Exchange (LMX)

- Leadership is based on the quality of the relationship between a leader and each individual follower
- Focus on relationship quality
  - how strong, trusting, respectful, and cooperative the relationship is between the leader and each member.
- Some members closer to leader
- Problems with LMX
  - perceptions of unfairness, resentment, favouritism exclusion, lower morale in the out-group
  - poor or unequal exchanges can create unfairness and division

Transformational vs Transactional

Transactional:	Transformational:
• gives rewards/punishments • monitor • focuses on tasks • ensures deadlines	• inspires • motivates • builds meaning • focuses on people

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the
office

Passive-Avoidant Leadership

- Avoid responsibility, delays decisions, does not follow through, weak leadership
- The leader is physically there, but leadership is missing
- Example:
  - “Manager who disappears during crisis”
- Two key forms

Passive-Avoidant Leadership

Two key forms	
Passive (Reactive) Leadership	**Avoidant (Laissez-faire) Leadership**
Only acts when problems become serious	Completely avoids:
Waits until things go wrong before stepping in	decision-making responsibility involvement
Example: Team is struggling → leader does nothing Deadline missed → THEN leader reacts	Example: “You all figure it out yourselves” No guidance, no direction

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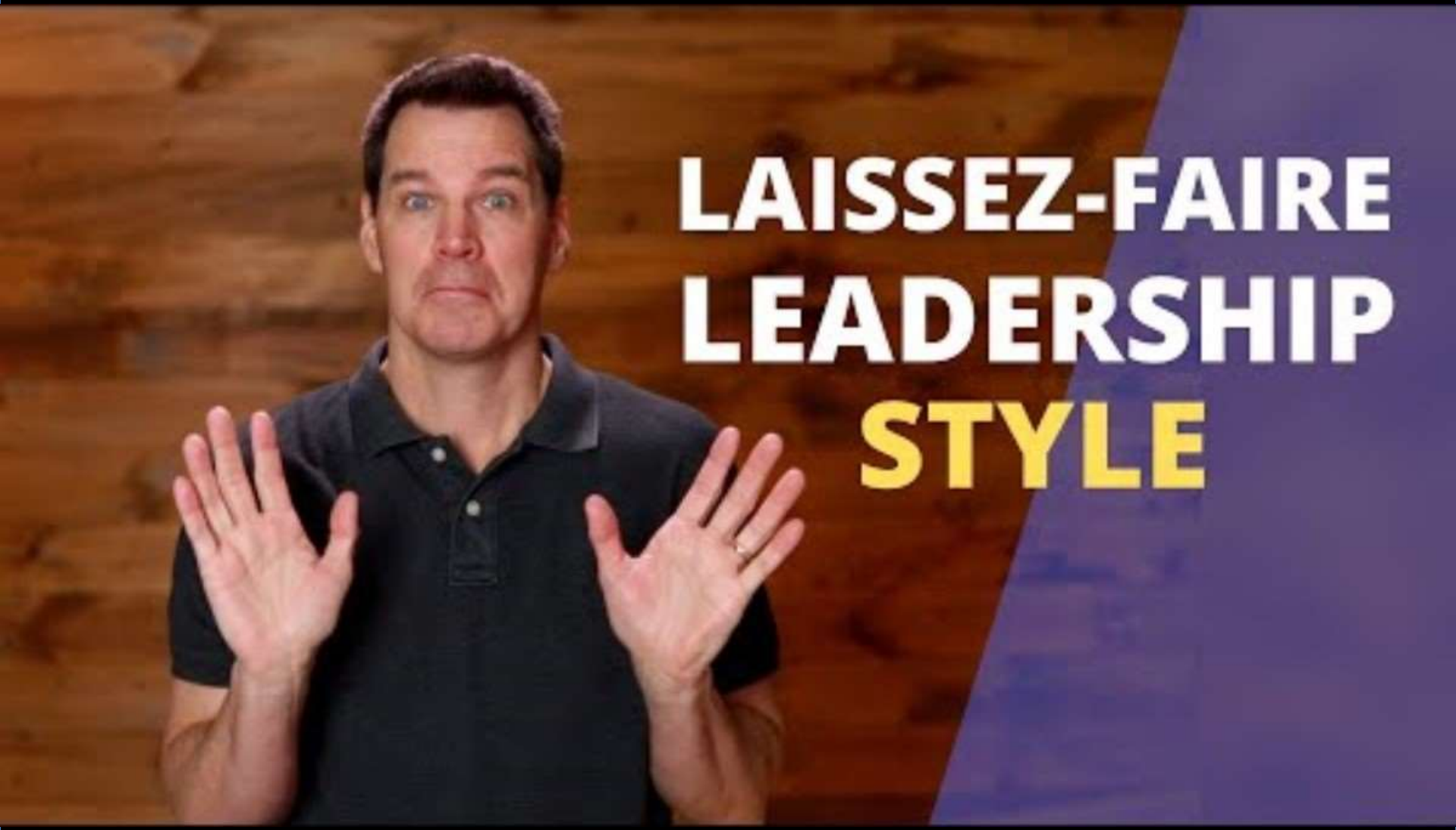

MindToolsVideos. (n.d.). *Laissez-faire leadership style*. YouTube.
0.55-6.23

MODERN PERSPECTIVES

Leadership is Contextual

- NO one best leadership style
- Depends on:
  - People
  - Situation
  - Environment
  - Team
  - Culture

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Emotional Intelligence

Being aware of	Leaders must:
• your own feelings • others' feelings	• understand emotions • manage relationships • communicate effectively

- EI is the ability of a leader to understand emotions, manage relationships, and communicate effectively.
- Leaders with high EI are better at building trust, resolving conflicts, and motivating their teams, which leads to better performance.
- It determines how well a leader connects, influences, and manages people

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Leader as Coach

- Modern leadership is no longer just about:
  - giving instructions
  - controlling work
  - monitoring performance
- Skills:
  - guide people
  - develop their skills
  - support their growth
  - help them perform better

Positive Leadership

- Positive leaders aim to build people up, not just manage them
- Build:
  - Confidence
    - helping people believe in themselves
    - increasing self-efficacy (belief in ability)
  - Motivation
    - inspiring people to want to do well
    - giving purpose and meaning
  - Psychological capital
    - Positive psychology (Lect 2)
      - handle stress better
      - stay motivated
      - recover from failure
      - perform better

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Summing up

- Leadership is not just a person
- Leadership is influence + relationships
- Leadership is contextual
- No “one best style”
- Modern leadership = shared & dynamic

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